Coup! – Teacher notes

Final Inkscape project for grade 9 (about 45 minutes; the bonus fills a second lesson). Students answer ten questions, one per screen: country, movement colour, state name, four 5-step sliders (how they rule, economy left–right, army, tradition–progress), what the nation is proud of, number of provinces and how they took power. The banner stays hidden until the last answer, then it is revealed together with a motto generated from the answers. The page then writes the Inkscape steps for exactly that banner.

Only the background gets exact numbers (W 300, H 180). Edit ▸ Resize Page to Selection makes the page the banner; after that every shape gets a size (W, H) and is placed with Object ▸ Align and Distribute (relative to Page), shifted with Object ▸ Transform ▸ Move, or dragged by eye to match the picture. Colours are typed as RGBA codes. Every command is in a menu or a toolbar.

How the answers shape the banner

Answer	Changes	Inkscape skills
Country + movement colour	palette (flag colours) and which colour leads	RGBA colours
How you rule × tradition (5 × 5)	field: bordered, chevron, hoist triangle, centre cross, diagonal band, two stripes, tricolours, wave, canton	Align; Union (cross, wave); Difference (chevron); Transform rotate + Intersection (diagonal); Rotate 90° (triangle)
Army (5)	behind the emblem: sunburst / compass star / halo / crossed bars / crossed blades	Star tool; Union; Difference; Transform rotate + Flip + Union
Economy (5)	frame: cog ring / ring / disc with outline / round shield / pointed shield	Difference; stroke; Union + Move; two Intersections + Move
Proud of (9)	symbol: gear, rising sun, waves, mountains in a round window, tree, atom, jewelled crown, crescent and star, star outline	Union, Difference, Intersection, Transform rotate/move
Provinces 1–9	a row of stars (or in the canton)	Duplicate, Distribute centers horizontally, Group
How you rule	name in an arc (strict rule) or straight; motto cut out of a band or flowed into a ribbon; frame thickness	Object to Path, Rotate 90°, Put on Path; Object to Path + Difference; Union + Flow into Frame
How you took power + all sliders	the motto, e.g. “Order, Steel, Victory”, “Bread for the Workers”, “Strength Through Obedience”	–

A sweep of all 21 750 combinations of the sliders, symbols and test palettes gives 855 different banner structures and 340 mottos – before country colours, movement colour and names, which make practically every banner unique. The same sweep checks colour contrast, overlaps and text fit (all passed).

Classroom notes

- The coup is fictional and tongue-in-cheek (the page says so); the country only supplies colours. The built-in list leaves out countries currently at war or in acute crisis; 'Other country' with colour pickers still lets anyone use any country. Edit COUNTRIES in inkscape/final/coup.js to change the list.
- 'Answer again' sends the student back to question 1 and clears the ticks, because the steps change.
- Progress is saved in the browser and shown on the landing page; 'Print my plan' prints the personal steps.
- Inkscape 1.4: Align and Distribute is relative to Page by default; Transform ▸ Move with 'Relative move' – positive values go right/down.

- The curved name (circle → Object to Path → Rotate 90° CW twice → Put on Path) was tested in Inkscape 1.4: the text starts at 9 o'clock.

Assessment (10 points)

Element	Points
Field: correct layout, 300 × 180, page resized, exact colours	2
Behind the emblem + frame (correct operation)	2
Symbol built with the given path operations	2
Stars in the right number and place	1
Name (arc with Put on Path, or centred) and motto (cut-out or flowed)	2
Frame; SVG + PNG handed in with the correct names	1

Twelve banners from twelve sets of answers



Brazil · iron fist · econ 1/5 · army 1/5 · trad 1/5 · industry · 1 · "Obedience, Steel, Peace"



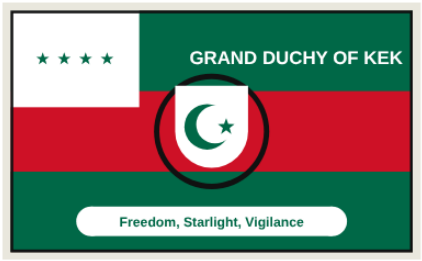
Japan · strict · econ 3/5 · army 4/5 · trad 2/5 · forests · 4 · "Timber for Everyone"



Germany · balanced · econ 5/5 · army 2/5 · trad 1/5 · freedom · 7 · "Calm Through Unity"



Sweden · open · econ 2/5 · army 5/5 · trad 2/5 · mountains · 1 · "Honour and Stone"



Mexico · free elections · econ 4/5 · army 3/5 · trad 1/5 · night · 4 · "Freedom, Starlight, Vigilance"



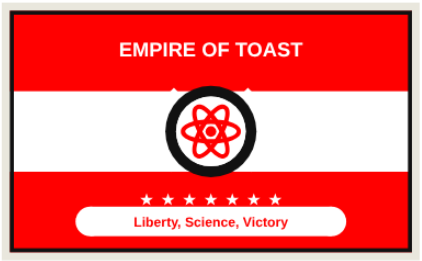
Ghana · iron fist · econ 1/5 · army 1/5 · trad 3/5 · sea · 7 · "Salt for the Workers"



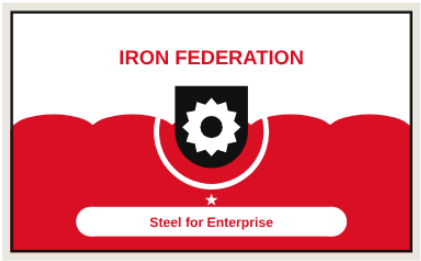
Greece · strict · econ 3/5 · army 4/5 · trad 2/5 · kings · 1 · "Strength Through Order"



India · balanced · econ 5/5 · army 2/5 · trad 3/5 · farming · 4 · "Balance and Bread"



Canada · open · econ 2/5 · army 5/5 · trad 2/5 · science · 7 · "Liberty, Science, Victory"



Peru · free elections · econ 4/5 · army 3/5 · trad 3/5 · industry · 1 · "Steel for Enterprise"



Jamaica · iron fist · econ 1/5 · army 1/5 · trad 3/5 · forests · 4 · "Peace Through Obedience"



Mongolia · strict · econ 3/5 · army 4/5 · trad 4/5 · freedom · 7 · "Progress and Hope"

Country · how they rule · economy, army, tradition (1–5) · proud of · provinces · generated motto